

Paraguay Residency Document Checklist

The concrete list of documents and steps for the standard temporary residency route — for citizens of Hague Apostille Convention countries with straightforward entry to Paraguay (e.g. Sweden, Spain, the USA, Australia, New Zealand, and similar).

How to use this checklist

Work through the sections in order. Documents in Section 1 take the longest to prepare because of apostille and translation lead times — start those first, ideally 6-8 weeks before your planned trip. Everything is general information, not legal advice; requirements and fees change, so confirm current details before you travel.

1. Documents to gather in your home country

Identity & civil status

☐ **Valid passport** — at least 6 months' validity remaining, with a blank visa page.

☐ **Birth certificate** — a certified copy, apostilled by your home country's competent authority.

☐ **Police clearance certificate ("antecedentes")** — a certificate of no criminal record from your home country (and any country you've lived in for an extended period), apostilled. Most have a validity window — check how long yours is accepted for before it needs to be reissued.

☐ **Marriage certificate (if applicable)** — apostilled, required if a spouse is included on the application.

Financial standing

☐ **Proof of income or means** — a bank reference letter, pension statement, or employment letter showing you can support yourself in Paraguay.

☐ **Bank statements** — recent statements from your home bank, typically the last 3-6 months.

Getting documents apostilled

Paraguay is a member of the Hague Apostille Convention, so documents issued in another member country only need an apostille stamp from that country's designated authority — not embassy legalization. The authority that issues apostilles is different in every country (often a foreign ministry, court, or notary body); confirm the correct office for your country before you start, and budget several weeks for turnaround.

Any document not already in Spanish must be translated by a translator recognized for official use once you are in Paraguay — plan for this as a separate step, not something you can do at home.

2. Before you travel

☐ **Confirm your route qualifies** — the standard route below is for straightforward-entry, Hague Apostille countries. If you hold other citizenship or plan to apply via investment, the requirements differ.

☐ **Book an entry appointment window** — know roughly which office you'll need to visit and its current hours before you land.

- Bring originals, not copies** — apostilled originals plus at least one photocopy of every document.
- Passport-style photos** — bring several recent passport-style photos — offices frequently ask for them on the spot.
- Budget for in-country costs** — government fees, sworn translation, notary costs, and living expenses while your application is processed. These add up beyond the headline residency fee.

3. In Paraguay

- Open the required bank account** — the standard route requires depositing a minimum amount, tied to Paraguay's minimum wage, into a local bank account — this is one of the first in-country steps.
- Sworn translation of foreign documents** — have your apostilled documents translated by a Paraguay-recognized sworn translator.
- Submit your application** — file with the relevant migration authority, with your complete, translated document set.
- Attend your appointment(s)** — biometrics and in-person review — arrive early, bring every original plus copies.
- Collect your cédula** — your Paraguayan ID card, issued once residency is approved — this is what you'll use day to day, not your passport.

4. After approval

- Understand renewal requirements** — temporary residency has a validity window before it converts to permanent — know the deadline and what maintains your status.
- Track physical-presence requirements** — extended absences from Paraguay during the temporary period can affect your path to permanent residency — know the limits before you book long trips home.
- Consider tax residency separately** — immigration residency and tax residency are not the same thing and have different rules — don't assume one triggers the other.

This is general information, not legal, tax, or immigration advice. Requirements, fees, and processing times change — verify current details with an official source or a licensed professional before you rely on them.

Want the full walkthrough?

This checklist covers the essentials. The Paraguay Residency Guide covers the complete temporary residency process step by step, the Investor Pass route, realistic costs and timelines, common rejection reasons, and what to expect at each office — plus templates and an updates feed when requirements change.

See what's inside → pararesi.com/guide